

# Stevens Good Ideas

Sep 27, 2026 · Adam Figgat

We're building a national, buyer-first marketplace for Pokémon cards: buyers post what they want, and sellers compete with fully public offers.

## How it works

1. A buyer posts a want and sets local-preferred or nationwide.
2. Matching sellers get an alert that links straight to the buyer's post.
3. Sellers reply with offers in the post's public thread.
4. The buyer picks the winning offer, and the post moves to Pending.
5. The deal closes as a regular transaction (shipping or local), and the post is marked sold or no deal.

## Users

Every account is a buyer or a seller. Sellers can be individuals or companies.

| Type                | Who                        | What they do                                                                   |
|---------------------|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Buyer               | Individuals                | Post wants, choose local or nationwide, pick the winning offer, close the post |
| Seller — individual | Collectors, casual sellers | Get alerts, post public offers                                                 |
| Seller — company    | Card shops, dealers        | Get alerts, post public offers under a business name                           |

## Post states

| State            | Meaning                                 |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Open — looking   | Accepting offers                        |
| Pending          | Buyer picked an offer; deal in progress |
| Closed — sold    | Deal completed                          |
| Closed — no deal | Buyer closed without buying             |

## Seller alerts

When a new want matches what a seller deals in, they get a message with a link that opens the buyer's post directly.

## Public offers

Every offer is visible to everyone. This keeps pricing transparent for sellers and holds buyers accountable for how they choose and follow through.

## Location and shipping

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Nationwide with shipping from day one. Each post carries the buyer's preference: local preferred or nationwide.

## Open questions

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- ☐ Alerts: how does a seller say what they want alerts for (sets, specific cards, price range, region)? Email, push, SMS?
- ☐ Local preferred: does it alert nearby sellers first, rank local offers higher, or both?
- ☐ Pending: can new offers still come in? Does it revert to Open if the deal stalls?
- ☐ Payment: does checkout happen on the platform (with buyer protection), or do buyer and seller pay each other directly?
- ☐ Buyer accountability: ratings, or a record of posts closed with no deal?
- ☐ Trust: required photos, graded-only listings, or counterfeit checks?
- ☐ Company sellers: how are businesses verified? Can one business have several team members?
- ☐ Money: seller fee on sold deals, seller subscriptions, or featured offers?

## Next session

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- Answer the open questions above.
- Define the MVP screens: post a want, offer thread, alert, state changes.

## Sources

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- [Sharetribe — reverse marketplace intro](#)
- [Surcal](#)